

the catapult papers



Name: _____

Score: _____

Notes for parents

The Main Series of The Catapult Papers provides a full set of SEAG-style practice assessments suitable for P7 pupils (or confident pupils at the end of P6). These papers offer a more challenging level of practice than the Warm-Up Series, reflecting the balance and pace of the official assessments more closely. As with all Transfer Test preparation, children will meet a wide range of English and Maths concepts, including some that require recall of earlier learning.

The questions in this series have been written to give children a realistic sense of the difficulty and variety they will encounter in the actual SEAG papers. The progression across the series helps pupils build accuracy, fluency, and familiarity with the demands of the assessment. Many families use these tests after completing the Warm-Up Series, though the order of use is entirely flexible.

The official time limit for the Transfer Test is 60 minutes. However, because this is a practice paper, no time limit is printed. Parents may decide how long to allow for completion, depending on confidence, focus, and stage of preparation.

This test paper may be written on, but answers must be recorded on the separate answer sheet provided. Guidance on how to do this is included at the top of that page. An answers page is also included for marking. Each correct answer is worth one mark, and no question carries more than one mark. Half-marks should not be awarded. In the English section, misspelled answers should only be accepted when spelling is not part of the skill being tested. When spelling accuracy is required (e.g. plurals, verb endings, homophones), an incorrectly spelled answer should not be counted as correct.

Spaces for recording the final score are provided on both the cover page and the answer sheet. Parents may record the result as a percentage or as a score out of 56.

Finally, please remember that these are practice tests. It is normal for children to make mistakes as they adjust to the level of challenge. The purpose of the Main Series is to develop confidence, build stamina, and strengthen the range of skills needed for the SEAG assessment. Consistent practice and calm encouragement are the most effective supports during this stage of preparation.

Permission to use this paper is granted for one child only. No photocopying or sharing of the test is permitted. A separate set of The Catapult Papers is available exclusively for schools.

English

In this exercise there are some mistakes with **punctuation** or use of **capital letters**. On each numbered line there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and **mark its letter on your answer sheet**. If there is **no** mistake, mark **N**.

Punctuation Exercise

- 1** 'I've never seen a storm this strong, shouted the fisherman as he held the wheel.
A B C D
- 2** The painting (which had taken months to complete hung proudly on her wall.
A B C D
- 3** Shauna's eyes could only focus on the glistening brilliance of the geeses' feathers.
A B C D
- 4** Entrants are required to arrive no later than seven o'clock in the morning.
A B C D
- 5** 'Find me Someone who's willing to work day and night,' said the manager, 'and I
A B C
I guarantee they'll be successful.'
D

In this exercise you have to choose the **best** word, or **group of words**, to complete each numbered line so that the sentences make sense and are written in correct English. Choose the best answer and **mark its letter on your answer sheet**.

Grammar Exercise

6 Rachel crept

slow
A

quick
B

gentle
C

lovely
D

upstairs
E

, hoping that the others wouldn't notice.

7

Them
A

These
B

Those
C

They
D

That
E

 flowers that I am now holding in my hand were taken from Mrs Newsome's garden.

8 She felt most at ease

among
A

between
B

through
C

throughout
D

to
E

 her group of closest friends.

9 I have never

ran
A

run
B

been running
C

gone running
D

went running
E

 a marathon in my life.

10 I thought our performance was great, but Geraldine and Maggie believed that

there's
A

they're
B

theirs
C

there
D

their
E

 was the best.

In this exercise there are some **spelling** mistakes. On each numbered line there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and mark its letter on your answer sheet. If there is no mistake, mark N.

Spelling Exercise

11

It took several attempts to figuer out the correct route through the forest maze.

A

B

C

D

12

Scott was so exhausted by his day's work that he couldn't even stand upright.

A

B

C

D

13

The student made a very strong argument for the exsistence of aliens.

A

B

C

D

14

'There are far too many cloathes in this wardrobe, Pat!' complained Mrs Gill.

A

B

C

D

15

They were desperate for the identity of the thief to be revealed but would have

A

B

C

to wait untill the next movie.

D

Read the whole passage carefully, then answer the questions that follow.

The Boy Between Bars

1. 'PULL!!'
2. Ewan's best friend's arms were grasped tightly around his waist, with another kid's
3. arms grasped tightly around THAT waist, with another kid's arms grasped tightly
4. around THAT one (and this went on thirty more times), forming the least-fun version
5. of the Conga any human could perform.
6. The cry came from Mrs Thorncroft for the class to try to dislodge Ewan from his
7. current situation: his poor head wedged between the steel bars of the school fence.
8. He had found it quite easy to push his head through (this may have been due to the
9. stray puppy that he was wanting to reach and pet). Pulling his head out again was
10. the problem.
11. Daresh had been sent back to the classroom to fetch some squirty hand-soap; it
12. could hopefully smooth a passage for Ewan's head (Gina was certain that Daresh
13. had fetched the glue instead).
14. The whole afternoon was a waste of time and energy, vainly attempting to free
15. Ewan. Emergency services were called in but their only 'solution' involved a
16. chainsaw. It turned out that this would not work as:
17. **(a)** Ewan wasn't particularly keen on this;
18. **(b)** it was an old, prestigious, steel fence – the local council would deny permission
19. to cut it apart.
20. And so Ewan's new life was to be built around his new prison. Two beds were
21. wheeled out for him: one for his body on one side of the fence, and one for his
22. head on the other (he had to lie face-down, of course); a tent was erected around
23. him; each frustrated parent took turns spending a night beside him.
24. Nights turned into weeks. Bitter classmates had to have their daily classes
25. outdoors in their new 'mobile classroom' (the tent). An even more resentful Mrs
26. Thorncroft had to stand outside it and teach (it wasn't a big tent). Although this
27. embarrassed Ewan initially, his feeling of guilt was somewhat eased by the huge,
28. outdoor flatscreen TV that became a fixture in his tent (once school was over).

29. Weeks turned into months. His flatscreen TV was upgraded to a cinema room.
30. There was his treadmill, his mini-trampoline, his own personal chef who wheeled
31. out a trolley of fine-dining delights each day.
32. Months turned into years. Ewan didn't have to go see the world. The world came
33. to see *him*. There was no class trip to the zoo; rather, it was the zoo's trip to Ewan
34. – each animal being paraded before him. There were no trips to the beach;
35. instead, lorries of sand were transported to his abode, accompanied by palm
36. trees and a jacuzzi.
37. 'The Boy Between Bars' became an international celebrity. News reporters from
38. around the globe reported on his 'plight'. Temporary chat show studios were
39. constructed around him. He welcomed the attention. For a while.
40. Eventually, the fame and publicity became too much for him (the final straw was
41. the plan to build a new secondary school around him). Ewan enlisted the help of
42. a lawyer to demand that all his structures be dismantled, all 'servants' be
43. removed, all family members leave him alone. The lawyer, who was all-too-aware
44. of the size of Ewan's bank balance was unsurprisingly happy to help. Life
45. returned to the way it was that first moment he tried to reach the puppy.
46. And so, with his head stuck between the same bars, a teenage Ewan stood alone
47. on a damp, cold, dark night. No bed to comfort him. No tent to shield him. No
48. entertainment to distract him. For the first time in his life, he was truly homeless.
49. It was that very same night that an old dog came along, strangely familiar-looking
50. to Ewan. It drew close to him but not close enough. He tried to pet it. He longed
51. to scratch its ears and feel some warm contact. In fact, so desperate was Ewan to
52. reach it, that he did something he hadn't considered doing ever since that fateful
53. day many years ago. He PUSHED.
54. He wriggled. He stretched, twisted and contorted himself so wildly that it's a
55. wonder his shoulders didn't pop out. Ewan didn't notice any pain. He wasn't
56. aware that he was using so much force to reach the dog that the steel bars were
57. twisting, bending and breaking. Not only was head between the bars now, so was
58. his chest, then his waist, then his legs.
59. It was worth it. He landed with a thud beside his old acquaintance and they
60. cuddled a while. After that, they decided to go for a walk.

Please answer these questions. (Look at the passage again if you need to.)
You should choose the **best** answer and mark its letter on your answer sheet.

16

Which of the following words best describes the mood of this story?

- A tense
- B absurd
- C romantic
- D mysterious
- E adventurous

17

Look at lines 49 - 60. Which of the following statements best summarises the final lesson that the author is trying to teach us?

- A Children should be very careful to stay within their boundaries.
- B Let other people decide what you should do with your life.
- C Don't let others hold you back; 'push through' and make new discoveries.
- D Humans can be very creative during difficult times.
- E School is a prison.

18

Ewan's classmates are described as 'bitter' on line 24.

Which other line in the passage contains a word that is similar in meaning to 'bitter'?

- A line 4
- B line 22
- C line 23
- D line 25
- E line 38

19

Which of the following things is NOT mentioned in the passage as making an appearance at Ewan's 'home'?

- A a dog
- B exercise equipment
- C high-quality food
- D palm trees
- E chat show studios

20

Which of the following words in the passage means 'respected and admired because of its high quality'?

- A dislodge (line 6)
- B prestigious (line 18)
- C upgraded (line 29)
- D fine-dining (line 31)
- E contorted (line 54)

21

Look at lines 29 - 45. What made Ewan finally decide to have his 'home' dismantled?

- A the advice of his lawyer
- B his appearance on chat shows
- C his guilt at having 'servants'
- D the plans to build a secondary school around him
- E his desire to be back at his parents' home

22

What part of speech is the word 'wonder' (line 55)?

- A noun
- B adjective
- C verb
- D adverb
- E pronoun

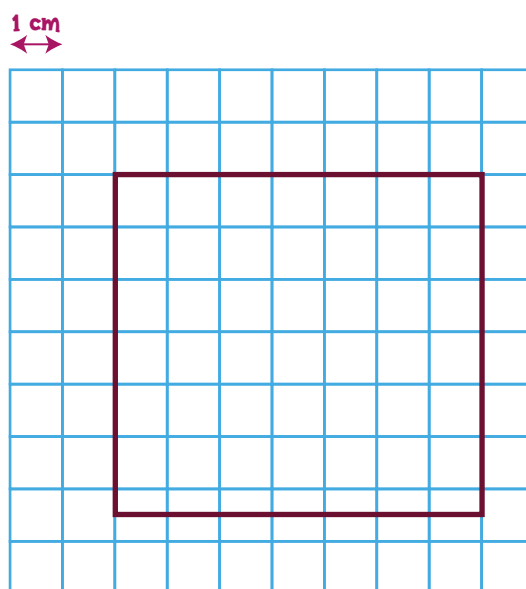
For these questions you have to **write your answers**, neatly, in the boxes provided on your answer sheet.

- 23** Which adverb in lines 14 - 19 tells us that the efforts to remove Ewan from the fence were 'fruitless' or 'useless'?
- 24** Which word in lines 29 - 36 means the same as 'home' or 'house'?
- 25** Look at lines 1 - 5. How many children in total are trying to pull Ewan from the bars?
- 26** '...it's a wonder his shoulders didn't pop out.' (lines 54 - 55)
'Pop' is an example of onomatopoeia.
Which other word in lines 54 - 60 is an example of onomatopoeia?
- 27** The word 'attention' appears on line 39.
Which word in the next paragraph has a similar meaning?
- 28** Which one part of speech are the following words as they appear in line 54?
wriggled, stretched, twisted, contorted

Maths

29

A quadrilateral is drawn onto a square grid. Each square on the grid has a side measuring 1 cm.



What is the area of the quadrilateral that has been drawn onto the grid?

- A** 42 cm² **B** 45 cm² **C** 45.25 cm² **D** 45.5 cm² **E** 45.75 cm²

30

How many hours are there in 4½ days?

- A** 96 hours
B 96.5 hours
C 108 hours
D 120 hours
E 270 hours

31

The distance from Chrissy's house to the gate of the local park is 1.5 kilometres.



It took Chrissy five minutes to cycle from her house to the gate of the local park. She cycled at the same speed throughout the journey.

How many metres had Chrissy travelled after two minutes?

- A** 30 m **B** 60 m **C** 150 m **D** 300 m **E** 600 m
-

32

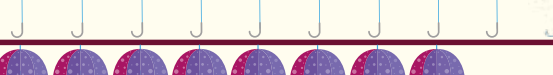
A plane has 40 seats in first class and 28 rows of six seats in economy. 22 seats are empty during one journey.

How many passengers are on board the plane?

- A** 146 passengers
B 180 passengers
C 186 passengers
D 194 passengers
E 208 passengers
-

33

This pictogram shows the number of days that it rained each month in the UK in 2022.

Month	Rainy Days
January	
February	
March	
April	
May	
June	
July	
August	
September	
October	
November	
December	

 = 2 rainy days

How many days did it rain in total for October, November and December combined?

- A 27 days
- B 28 days
- C 53 days
- D 54 days
- E 55 days

34

Through how many degrees does the hour hand on a clock move between 1.00 pm and 5.00 pm?

- A 90° B 120° C 135° D 150° E 180°
-

35

Which decimal number is equal to $1\frac{5}{20}$?

- A 0.15 B 0.125 C 0.25 D 0.35 E 0.75
-

36

$$a^2 + 15 = 40$$

What is the value of the letter a?

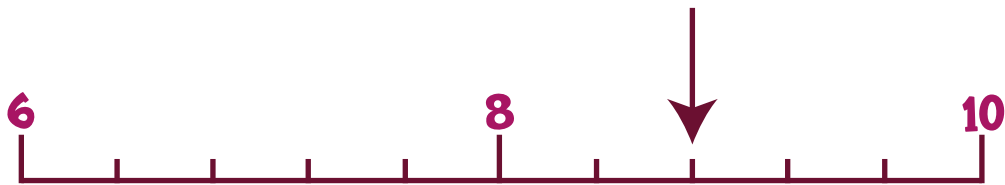
- A 5 B 12.5 C 25 D 50 E 55
-

37

Which of the following 3D shapes has exactly double the number of edges of a triangular-based pyramid?

- A square-based pyramid
B cylinder
C triangular prism
D hexagonal prism
E cube
-

38



At which number is the arrow pointing?

A 8.2

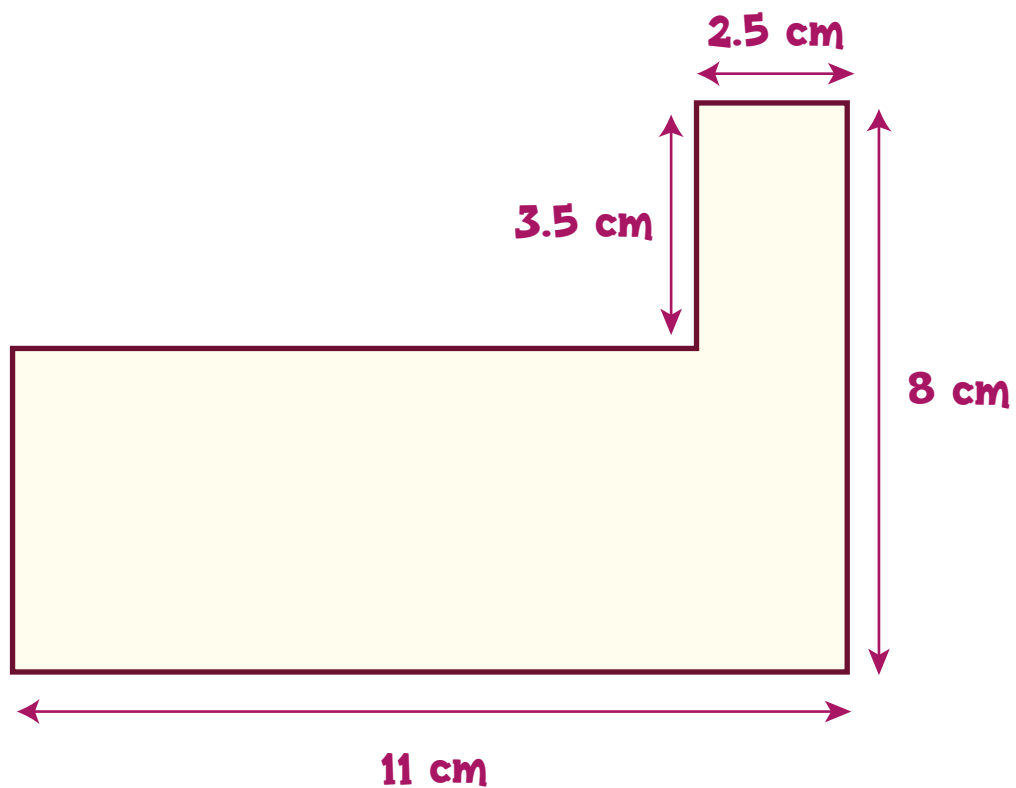
B 8.5

C 8.8

D 9

E 10

39



What is the perimeter of this shape?

A 25 cm

B 37 cm

C 38 cm

D 39 cm

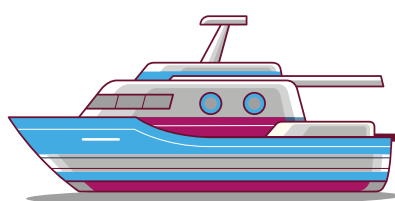
E 88 cm

40

A ferry sails from Seaport to Rockhaven daily.

The table below shows the first and final sailing times for each day.

	First Sailing	Final Sailing
Mon - Fri	0745	2045
Sat - Sun	0810	2010



Ferries sail every
20 minutes from
first sailing to
final sailing.

Which of the times below is an actual departure time for one of the ferries?

- A Tuesday 9.05 pm
- B Wednesday 8.25 pm
- C Friday 10.15 am
- D Saturday 8.40 am
- E Sunday 9.30 pm

41

The temperature in St Petersburg is -11°C .
It is 18°C warmer in Brisbane.

What is the temperature in Brisbane?

- A 29°C
- B 17°C
- C 7°C
- D -7°C
- E -29°C

42

This function machine has a calculation missing.

IN	calculation 1	OUT
5	$\longrightarrow$	20
11.5	$\longrightarrow$	72

Which of these calculations would work in the function machine for BOTH pairs of numbers?

A $\div 2$

B $+ 2$

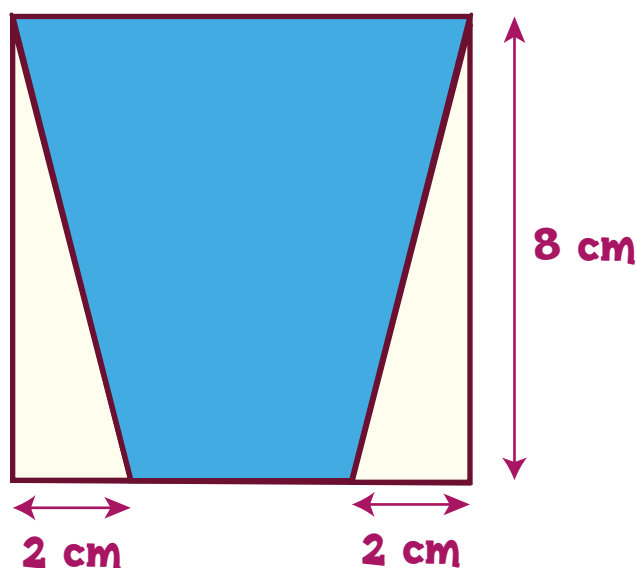
C $\times 2$

D -2

E -2.5

43

Two scalene triangles and a trapezium are combined to make this square.



What is the area of the trapezium?

A 16 cm^2

B 24 cm^2

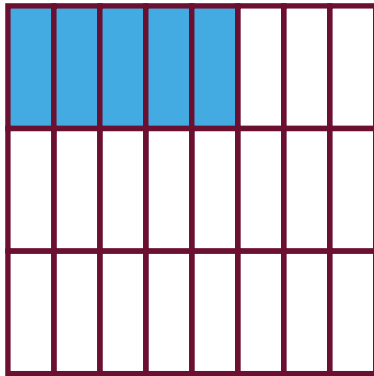
C 32 cm^2

D 40 cm^2

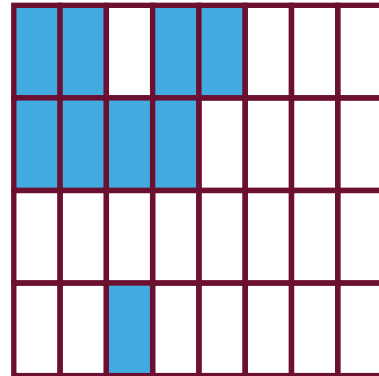
E 48 cm^2

44

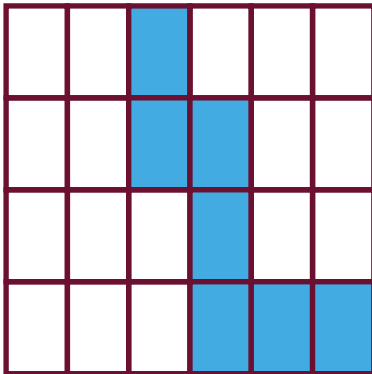
SHAPE A



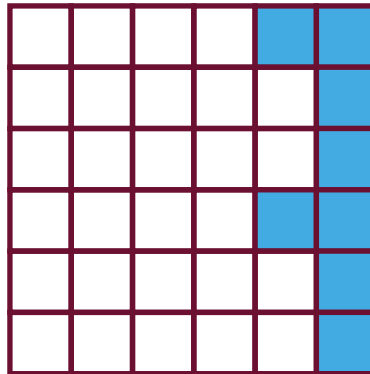
SHAPE B



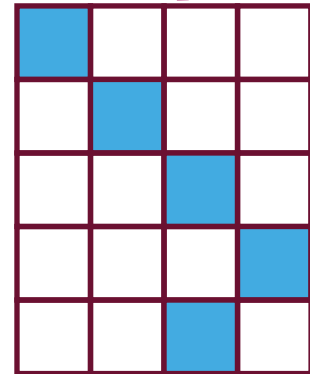
SHAPE C



SHAPE D



SHAPE E



Which of these shapes has had 25% of its parts shaded?

- A** Shape A
- B** Shape B
- C** Shape C
- D** Shape D
- E** Shape E

45

How many of the first 12 square numbers are also divisible by three?

- A 1 square number
 - B 2 square numbers
 - C 3 square numbers
 - D 4 square numbers
 - E 5 square numbers
-

46

The total length of all the edges on a cube is 60 cm.

What is the volume of the cube?

- A 125 cm³ B 216 cm³ C 360 cm³ D 1000 cm³ E 3375 cm³
-

47

The number 24.5 is equal to how many hundredths?

- A 0.245 hundredths
 - B 24.5 hundredths
 - C 245 hundredths
 - D 2450 hundredths
 - E 24500 hundredths
-

48

A rectangle has a perimeter of 24 cm. The length of the rectangle is double the width of the rectangle.

What is the length of the rectangle?

- A 4 cm B 6 cm C 8 cm D 10 cm E 12 cm

49

This table shows the finishing times for six sprinters who ran a 100-metre race.



sprinter	finishing time
Akani	9.93 seconds
Andre	9.89 seconds
Bingtian	9.98 seconds
Fred	9.84 seconds
Lamont	9.8 seconds
Ronnie	9.95 seconds

What was the difference in times between the sprinter who won the race and the sprinter who finished third?

- A 0.09 seconds
- B 0.9 seconds
- C 0.5 seconds
- D 0.05 seconds
- E 0.04 seconds

50

Gerard has exactly £2.70. It is made up entirely of 20 pence coins and 10 pence coins.

He has the same number of 20p coins as 10p coins.

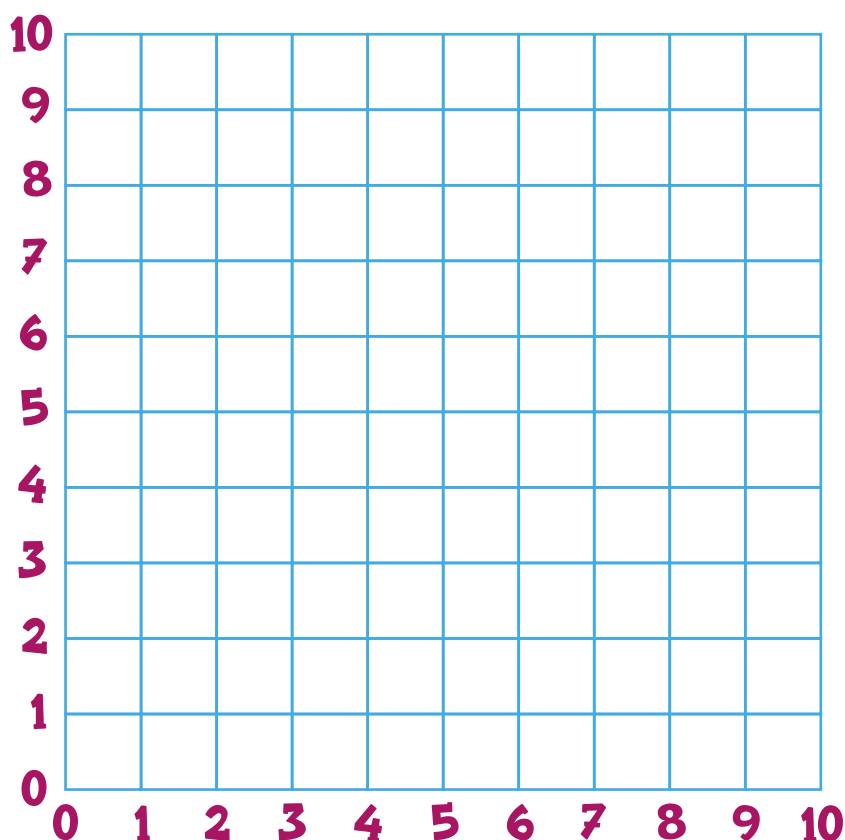
How many of each coin does Gerard have?

- A 5 of each coin
- B 6 of each coin
- C 7 of each coin
- D 8 of each coin
- E 9 of each coin

For questions 51 - 56, you have to **write your answers** in the boxes provided on your answer sheet. The units of measurement have been given.

51

The coordinates (1,5), (3,3) and (6,6) are to be plotted onto this grid.



A fourth point must be plotted onto the grid to complete the four corners of a rectangle.

What are the coordinates of the fourth point?

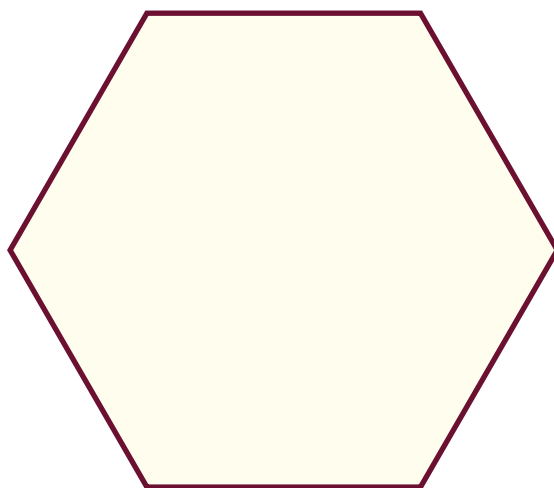
.....

52

$$\begin{array}{r} 7 \quad 3 \quad 1 \quad 1 \\ - \quad \square \quad \square \quad \square \quad \square \\ \hline 2 \quad 6 \quad 8 \quad 7 \end{array}$$

What is the missing number in this subtraction?

53



How many lines of symmetry are there in a regular hexagon?

54

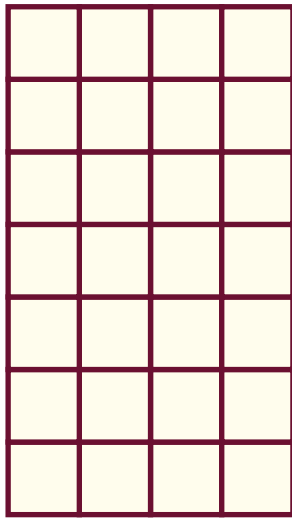
$$\frac{12}{18} = \frac{?}{?}$$

Tommy finds an equivalent fraction for $\frac{12}{18}$. The numerator of the second fraction is two more than the numerator of the first fraction.

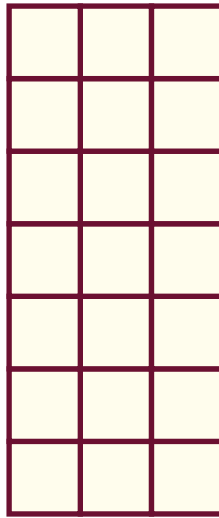
What is the denominator in Gerard's new fraction?

55

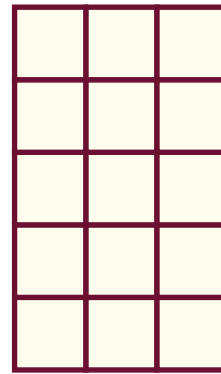
This sequence is working backwards.



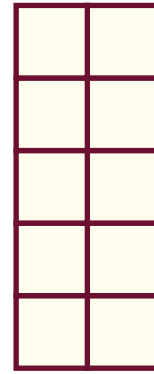
Pattern 7



Pattern 6



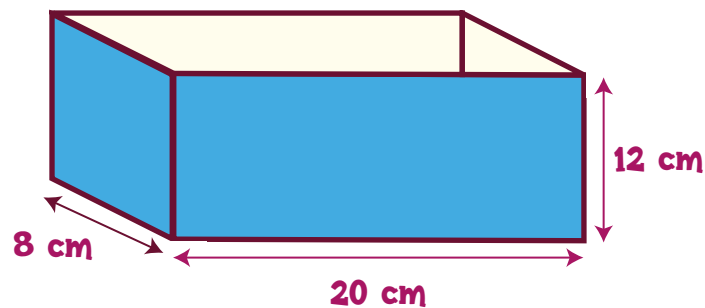
Pattern 5



Pattern 4

How many squares will there be in Pattern 3?

56



What is the volume of this box?

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Catapult is a one-man tuition service. Based in East Belfast, Trevor Veale has been working with primary pupils from 4 to 11-years-old on a full-time basis since 2019.

A former Year 3 and Year 6 teacher, Trevor is now fully booked as a private tutor through to the end of 2030. His teaching resources not only include *The Catapult Papers*, but also *Target Practice* and *Rooted*. All of these materials can be purchased at www.catapult-tuition.com